Vigilance Bulletin

सतर्कता बुलेटिन

Vigilance Cell · All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bhopal

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Probity for Prosperity

सत्यनिष्ठा से समृद्धि

Probity means strict honesty and integrity in public life. This year's theme links it with prosperity: institutions that are fair and transparent use their resources better, earn public trust and serve people better. For a hospital, prosperity means better care for every patient who walks through our gates.

MESSAGE

From the Executive Director

Vigilance Awareness Week is a good moment to remind ourselves why we are here. Every day, thousands of patients and their families come to AIIMS Bhopal trusting that they will be treated fairly, that their care will depend on need and not on influence, and that public money spent on their behalf will be spent well. That trust is our most valuable asset.

This year's theme makes a simple point: integrity is not a cost to an institution; it is what makes growth possible. Transparent procurement brings better equipment for the same money. Fair recruitment brings in the best people. Clear, rule-based processes protect honest staff from pressure.

I urge every member of the AIIMS Bhopal family – faculty, residents, nurses, administrative and technical staff – to take the integrity pledge, join this week's activities, and carry the spirit of probity into our daily work.

Lt Gen (Dr) Narendra Kotwal, AVSM, SM, VSM (Retd)
Executive Director, AIIMS Bhopal

MESSAGE

From the Chief Vigilance Officer

Vigilance is not only about finding wrongdoing after the event. Its most useful work is preventive: simplifying procedures, using technology, removing unnecessary discretion, and helping colleagues recognise risks before they become problems.

In a hospital these risks are close to us – in how we buy medicines and equipment, how we manage stores, how patients get appointments and beds, and how we deal with suppliers and industry. Most lapses begin as small compromises that seem harmless at the time.

The Vigilance Cell is here to support, not only to scrutinise. If you see a process that invites misuse, tell us: a systemic fix protects everyone. I invite you to read this bulletin, take the daily quiz, and send us your suggestions.

Prof (Dr) Debasis Biswas
Chief Vigilance Officer, AIIMS Bhopal
Professor & Head, Microbiology

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About this bulletin

This first issue of the Vigilance Bulletin explains preventive vigilance in plain language, answers questions we are often asked, and tells you how to raise a concern safely. It is meant to be read in ten minutes and kept for reference. Suggestions for future issues are welcome at **vigilancecell@aiimsbhopal.edu.in**.

FEATURE

Preventive vigilance: everyone's job

When people hear "vigilance", they often think of inquiries and penalties. That is only one part of the picture, and not the most important one.

The Central Vigilance Commission's Vigilance Manual describes preventive vigilance as a package of measures to improve systems and procedures, reduce opportunities for corruption and promote transparency. Its starting point is that corruption is usually a failure of systems, controls and organisational culture – not only of one dishonest individual.

That changes who is responsible. Implementing preventive vigilance is the duty of the management as a whole, and in fact of every official, not just of the vigilance department. Every supervisory officer is expected to ensure the integrity of the people working under them.

What does this look like in practice? The Manual returns to a few simple ideas:

- **Simplify and standardise rules**, so that there is less room for discretion and arbitrariness.
- **Use technology.** e-Procurement, e-Office and online services leave a clear electronic record and reduce face-to-face dealings.
- **Be transparent.** When people know the rules, fees and timelines, middlemen lose their value.
- **Fix accountability.** Clear responsibility at each level makes it easier to act when something goes wrong.
- **Detect early and act quickly.** Prompt action limits losses and deters others; delay encourages them.
- **Build awareness.** Simple do's and don'ts and regular training help honest staff avoid unintended lapses.

None of this needs special powers. A store keeper who will not certify goods before they arrive, a doctor who declares a link with a company before joining a purchase committee, a clerk who insists on the queue – each of them is practising preventive vigilance.

Three faces of vigilance

Punitive
Investigating misconduct and taking disciplinary or legal action once it has happened.

Preventive
Improving systems so that misconduct is harder to commit and easier to detect.

Participative
Involving employees and citizens through awareness, the integrity pledge and safe channels to report.

Why it matters in a hospital

Every rupee lost to waste or corruption is a rupee not spent on patient care. Every patient who has to "know someone" to get a bed loses faith in a public institution. Probity is part of good clinical care.

KNOW THE RISKS

Where a hospital is most vulnerable

The Manual names procurement and human-resource processes such as recruitment, promotion, transfer and posting among the major corruption-prone areas in every organisation. Applied to a teaching hospital, the areas that need the most care are:

- Procurement of drugs, consumables and equipment
- Stores and inventory: receipt, issue and condemnation
- Recruitment, outsourcing and manpower contracts
- Works, maintenance and annual maintenance contracts
- Patient services: appointments, admission, beds and investigation queues
- Cash counters, billing and refunds
- Dealings with pharmaceutical and device companies
- Certificates, medical records and reports

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Frequently asked questions

What is a "vigilance angle"?

Broadly, a matter has a vigilance angle when it involves corruption or abuse of an official position – for example demanding or accepting gratification, using a position to obtain an advantage, holding assets disproportionate to known income, or misappropriation, forgery or cheating. Gross or wilful negligence, reckless decisions and blatant violation of laid-down procedures can also have a vigilance angle. Honest mistakes made in good faith are not the target.

I took a decision in good faith that later turned out wrong. Am I at risk?

The system distinguishes bona fide decisions from mala fide ones. The Prevention of Corruption Act also requires prior approval before any inquiry into a decision taken by a public servant in the discharge of official functions. Your best protection is to follow the laid-down procedure, record your reasons on file, and seek advice when in doubt.

Is giving a bribe also an offence?

Yes. Since the 2018 amendment to the Prevention of Corruption Act, giving or offering a bribe is a specific offence, not only taking one. A person who is compelled to give a bribe and reports it to the law enforcement authorities within seven days is protected.

Can I accept a gift?

Do not accept any gift, hospitality or favour from anyone who has, or may have, official dealings with you: suppliers, contractors, bidders, pharmaceutical or device companies, or patients seeking a favour. For gifts on family occasions, the Conduct Rules require you to report those above the prescribed limits. When in doubt, decline politely.

What is a conflict of interest, and what should I do?

It arises when your personal interest, or that of a relative or friend, could affect an official decision. Declare it in writing to the competent authority and step away from that decision. An undeclared conflict is a problem even if the decision itself was fair.

Can I complain anonymously?

The Central Vigilance Commission does not act on anonymous or pseudonymous complaints. If you fear reprisal, use the whistle-blower route under the PIDPI Resolution (see page 4): your identity is kept confidential by the Commission.

What is an Integrity Pact?

It is a written agreement between the organisation and all bidders in a tender that neither side will indulge in bribery, collusion or bid rigging. Its implementation is overseen by Independent External Monitors, and the Central Vigilance Commission is the nodal authority for it.

Will raising a concern get me into trouble?

Genuine concerns raised in good faith through proper channels are welcome. Make your complaint specific and verifiable. Deliberately false or malicious complaints are themselves misconduct.

Do

- ✓ Keep passwords and OTPs to yourself; use multi-factor login
- ✓ Lock your screen whenever you step away
- ✓ Use your official email ID for official work
- ✓ Buy through GeM and e-procurement; follow GFR 2017
- ✓ Declare any conflict of interest in writing
- ✓ Record the reasons for your decisions on file
- ✓ Follow the queue for patient services
- ✓ Report suspicious requests, offers and emails

Don't

- × Accept gifts or hospitality from suppliers or industry
- × Split orders to avoid tendering or higher sanction
- × Certify receipt of goods before delivery and inspection
- × Mark attendance on behalf of anyone else
- × Plug in unknown pen drives or install pirated software
- × Act as a go-between for patients seeking favours
- × Share official files or patient data on personal apps
- × Sit on a committee where you have a personal interest

SPEAK UP

How to raise a concern

ROUTE 1

Vigilance Cell, AIIMS Bhopal

Write to the Chief Vigilance Officer, AIIMS Bhopal, or email the Vigilance Cell.

vigilancecell@aiimsbhopal.edu.in

ROUTE 2

CVC complaint portal

Lodge a complaint online with the Central Vigilance Commission, giving your name and contact details.

portal.cvc.gov.in

ROUTE 3 · WHISTLE BLOWER

PIDPI Resolution

Send a written complaint in a closed envelope superscribed **"Complaint under The Public Interest Disclosure"**, to:

The Secretary, Central Vigilance Commission, Satarkta Bhawan, Block 'A', GPO Complex, INA, New Delhi – 110023

A good complaint is

- **Specific:** who, what, when and where
- **Verifiable:** point to records or evidence
- **Signed:** give your name and address – for PIDPI, at the start or end of the complaint or in a separate letter, not in the body
- **Private:** do not publicise it; this protects you and the inquiry

Before you decide: a one-minute integrity check

1. Is it within the law and the rules?
2. Would I be comfortable if my reasons were read by anyone?
3. Does anyone close to me gain from it?
4. Would I decide the same way for everyone in this situation?
5. Have I recorded my reasons on file?
6. If unsure, have I asked for advice?

THIS WEEK

Vigilance Awareness Week at AIIMS Bhopal

- Integrity Pledge ceremony for faculty, officers and staff
- Online competitions: poster, slogan and the daily quiz
- School outreach programme on ethics and integrity
- Street play (nukkad natak) in OPD areas
- Integrity e-Pledge drive with QR code standees across the campus
- This Vigilance Bulletin
- Social media awareness campaign
- Concluding session and felicitation of winners

TAKE PART

Daily Vigilance Quiz

10 new questions every day, in English and Hindi. Prizes and e-certificates.

vigilance-aiimsbhopal.github.io/quiz

Take the Integrity e-Pledge

On the Central Vigilance Commission's website, for you and your family.

pledge.cvc.nic.in

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This bulletin is for awareness. For authoritative provisions, refer to the CVC Vigilance Manual 2026 and the rules that apply to you.